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AWARDS AND RECOGNITION POLICY

International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc.

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Approved by	Board of Directors of International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc., Resolution No. 2026-01 dated November 11, 2026

1. Purpose and Scope

This Awards and Recognition Policy (the "Policy") establishes the formal rules, procedures, governance structure, eligibility requirements, evaluation standards, approval mechanisms and limitations applicable to all awards, recognitions, honorary titles, designations and distinctions conferred by International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc. (the "Association" or "IBPA").

This Policy applies to:

(a) all recognition programs administered by the Association;

(b) all individuals, entities or organizations nominated for recognition;

(c) all persons involved in the nomination, review, evaluation, recommendation or approval processes; and

(d) all awards conferred in the name of, under the authority of, or as a representation of the Association.

This Policy is intended to ensure that all recognition processes are conducted fairly, transparently, consistently, on the basis of merit and in compliance with ethical requirements, and that such processes do not result in impermissible private benefit, reputational harm or governance risks.

2. Authority and Governance

2.1 Authority of the Board of Directors

The Board of Directors retains ultimate authority over all of the Association's awards and recognition programs, including:

(a) creating, amending, suspending or discontinuing awards;

(b) approving recognition criteria and standards;

(c) approving final award recipients where required;

(d) overseeing the integrity and credibility of recognition processes.

2.2 Delegation

The Board may delegate certain administrative, evaluative or procedural functions to:

(a) the Awards & Recognition Committee;

(b) appointed expert panels;

(c) independent subject-matter experts;

(d) officers of the Association.

No such delegation transfers final governance authority unless expressly authorized.

3. Award and Recognition Categories

The Association may establish and administer several categories of recognition, including, without limitation:

(a) Professional Excellence Awards

(b) Industry Leadership Awards

(c) Innovation and Development Awards

(d) Education, Mentorship and Contribution Awards

(e) Emerging Professional Awards

(f) Lifetime Achievement Awards

(g) Honorary memberships or distinctions

(h) Certificates of merit or recognition

(i) Special awards conferred by the Board

Each category may be governed by separate eligibility criteria, evaluation standards and procedures established by the Board or an authorized committee.

4. Eligibility Requirements

4.1 General Requirements

Unless otherwise established:

(a) candidates may be individuals, companies, brands, educators, organizations or institutions;

(b) candidates may be members or non-members of the Association;

(c) candidates must demonstrate documented professional activity, achievements, contribution or impact relevant to the award;

(d) candidates must meet the Association's ethical, professional and reputational standards.

4.2 Disqualification

A candidate may be disqualified at any stage if:

(a) false, misleading or materially incomplete information has been provided;

(b) the candidate does not meet the established requirements;

(c) the candidate has acted contrary to the Association's standards;

(d) the candidate's participation creates reputational, ethical or legal risks for the Association.

4.3 Additional Criteria

The Board or an authorized committee may establish additional eligibility requirements for specific awards, including geography, professional category, level of experience or an achievement threshold.

5. Nomination Procedures

5.1 Submission of Nominations

Nominations must be submitted in accordance with procedures established by the Association, which may include:

(a) online submission systems;

(b) written applications;

(c) nominations by invitation;

(d) internal nomination processes.

5.2 Required Documentation

Candidates may be required to provide:

(a) completed nomination or application forms;

(b) a professional portfolio or examples of completed work;

(c) documentation confirming achievements, certificates or qualifications;

(d) letters of recommendation or testimonials;

(e) additional materials relevant to the evaluation criteria.

5.3 Verification of Information

The Association reserves the right to:

(a) verify all information provided;

(b) request additional documentation or clarification;

(c) conduct independent verification or due diligence.

Failure to provide requested information may result in disqualification.

6. Evaluation and Review Process

6.1 Evaluating Bodies

Evaluation may be conducted by one or more of the following:

(a) the Awards & Recognition Committee;

(b) appointed juries;

(c) independent experts;

(d) evaluators appointed by the Board.

6.2 Evaluation Standards

Evaluation must be based on objective and subjective criteria, which may include:

(a) professional competence and technical quality;

(b) consistency and professional experience;

(c) originality, innovation and creativity;

(d) measurable impact on clients, students or the industry;

(e) contribution to professional development or education;

(f) compliance with ethical standards;

(g) reputation in the professional community.

6.3 Evaluation Methods

The Association may use:

(a) scoring systems;

(b) weighted criteria;

(c) qualitative assessment;

(d) comparative analysis;

(e) multi-stage evaluation procedures.

The specific methodology may vary by award category.

7. Conflict of Interest and Impartiality

7.1 Disclosure Requirements

All persons involved in nomination or evaluation processes must disclose any actual, potential or perceived conflict of interest.

7.2 Mandatory Recusal

A person must recuse himself or herself where a conflict exists, including, without limitation:

(a) family relationships;

(b) business or financial relationships;

(c) employment or partnership relationships;

(d) student–teacher relationships;

(e) direct competition;

(f) close personal relationships.

7.3 Enforcement

Failure to disclose a conflict of interest may result in:

(a) removal from the evaluation process;

(b) invalidation of results;

(c) other governance measures determined by the Board.

8. Selection and Final Approval

8.1 Recommendations

Evaluating bodies may produce:

(a) ranked lists of candidates;

(b) finalists;

(c) recommended award recipients.

8.2 Final Decision

The final decision on award recipients is made by:

(a) the Board of Directors; or

(b) a delegated body expressly authorized by the Board.

No recognition is final until approved in accordance with the Association's governance procedures.

9. Announcement and Presentation

The Association may, at its discretion:

(a) publicly announce recipients;

(b) present awards at events, ceremonies or conferences;

(c) publish results through official channels;

(d) issue certificates, titles, insignia or other forms of recognition.

The timing, format and manner of presentation are determined by the Association.

10. Revocation, Suspension and Review

The Association reserves the right to revoke, suspend or review any award if:

(a) the award was granted on the basis of false or misleading information;

(b) a conflict of interest materially influenced the decision;

(c) the recipient acts in violation of the Association's standards;

(d) the recipient acts in a manner that may damage the Association's reputation;

(e) an administrative or procedural error has occurred.

Any such decision is made by the Board of Directors after appropriate review.

11. Use of Awards, Titles and Recognition

Award recipients may use titles or recognition granted by the Association only:

(a) truthfully and without misleading anyone;

(b) in connection with the specific recognition conferred;

(c) in a manner that does not create the impression of a broader endorsement than actually granted.

The Association may revoke the right of use in the event of misuse or misrepresentation.

12. No Guarantee of an Award

Submitting a nomination or application does not guarantee:

(a) selection;

(b) reaching the final;

(c) receiving an award.

The Association reserves the right to:

(a) decline to confer an award in any category;

(b) reduce or increase the number of recipients;

(c) change or cancel recognition programs.

13. Limitation of Liability

To the maximum extent permitted by law, the Association is not liable for:

(a) the results of evaluation processes;

(b) award or recognition decisions;

(c) subjective perceptions of fairness or interpretation of criteria;

(d) any indirect or consequential effects of participation.

All decisions made under this Policy are final unless otherwise determined by the Board.

14. Compliance with Law and Organizational Standards

All recognition processes must be conducted in compliance with:

(a) applicable laws and regulations;

(b) the Association's governing documents;

(c) policies relating to ethics, conflicts of interest and professional standards.

No recognition program may be conducted in a manner that results in impermissible private benefit or violates the requirements of nonprofit law.

15. Relationship to Other Documents

This Policy applies together with:

- the Bylaws;
- the Code of Ethics;
- the Conflict of Interest Policy;
- the Professional Standards;
- the Governance Policy;
- the Committee Charters;
- the Records Retention Policy.

In the event of a conflict, the Bylaws prevail unless otherwise required by law.

16. Amendments

This Policy may be amended by the Board of Directors at any duly convened meeting or by lawful written consent.

17. Official Language

The official version of this Policy is maintained in English. Any translation is provided for convenience only. In the event of any discrepancy, the English version prevails.